

The Crucible – Act Three

Arthur Miller

Choose Your Own Path

Answer the following items completely.

1. Act Three is the climax of *The Crucible*. Discuss.
2. Identify the voice of reason in Act Three. Cite and discuss supporting evidence.
3. What does Abigail's refusal to answer Danforth's questions show about the status the trials have given her?
4. It was noted previously that public reputation makes or breaks one in Salem. How is the importance of reputation reflected in Act Three? In answering, consider who lies in Act Three (Elizabeth, Parris) and their motivation for doing so.
5. It seems that every time John Proctor, Giles Corey, and Francis Nurse try to defend their wives, they are accused of trying to overthrow the court. What would Reverend Parris have to lose if the defense's case was seriously considered? What would Danforth and the judges have to lose?

The End of the Road

Complete each of the following activities.

6. Some of Salem's accused attract trouble because they stand up for those already arrested. The court clearly believes in guilt by association. What do you think about the theory of guilt by association? Have you ever experienced it? Can it ever be valid? Explain your answer.
7. Danforth states that "a person is either with this court or [...] must be counted against it, there be no road between." In other words, there is no room for disagreement as far as he is concerned. What are some modern day scenarios where those in authority have taken that approach? Are there instances where this type of thinking is justified?

Ongoing Activity (II)

As promised, the Reverend Hale continues to develop as *The Crucible* progresses. In monitoring his character, you are advised to consider

- a. why Hale suggests Proctor have a lawyer, and what this reveals about Hale's attitude toward the trial. Is this a change?
- b. what evidence exists that Hale no longer believes the testimony and crying of Abigail and her cohort.